BENGALURU FC
SCOUTING & RECRUITMENT REPORT
HISTORICAL RECRUITMENT ANALYSIS & STRATEGIC SQUAD PLANNING (2020/21 – 2024/25)

Prepared by: Ayush Singh Focus Club: Bengaluru FC (ISL)
Primary Analytical Period: 2020/21 – 2024/25 Framework: Gap-Driven Recruitment Engine
Data Sources: Wikipedia Historicals & Transfermarkt Data Integrity: 100% Verified Non-Synthetic Data

CONFIDENTIAL SCOUTING DOSSIER | FOR TECHNICAL DIRECTORS & SPORTING EXECUTIVES

01. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY
Analytical Scope, Dashboard Overview & Methodological Pipeline

SEASONS ANALYSED

5
2020/21 to 2024/25

TOTAL TRANSFERS

106
101 Ext + 5 Academy

TOTAL INBOUND

59
54 Ext + 5 Academy

AVG SIGNING AGE

27.0y
Bimodal (24-26 & 30+)

FREE AGENT %

92.6%
50/54 External Free

DOMESTIC RATIO

57.4%
31 Domestic Signings

THE ANALYTICAL RECRUITMENT FLOW:

Historical Transfers → Recruitment Analysis → Recruitment Identity → Player Pathways → Market Value Trajectory → Current Squad Analysis → Squad Gaps Detection → Ideal Recruitment Profiles → Multi-Criteria Shortlisting → Final Strategic Recommendations

1. Recruitment Architecture

Bengaluru FC's transfer strategy is fundamentally shaped by
opportunistic free-agent contract captures and domestic swaps.
With 92.6% of external arrivals acquired on free transfers (93.2%
including academy promotions), financial exposure is tightly
regulated, requiring high precision in medical, tactical, and
motivational vetting.

2. Current Squad Dynamics

The current roster holds an average age of 27.3 years. While the central defensive core (Jovanovi■, Bheke, Sana Singh) and anchor Gurpreet Singh Sandhu provide seasoned stability, the offensive spine has entered an acute succession window with senior starters averaging 35+ years.

3. Strategic Imperatives

To maintain championship contention in upcoming campaigns, the
sporting department must execute an immediate transition plan: securing a high-pressing U24 striker, acquiring a prime-age
creative playmaker (No. 8/10), and strengthening wide defensive
depth without blocking academy minutes.

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02. CLUB RECRUITMENT IDENTITY
Empirical Evaluation of Bengaluru FC's Historical Transfer Blueprint

AVERAGE SIGNING AGE

27.0 Years
Bimodal (24-26 & 30+)

TOP RECRUITED AREA

Defenders (20)
Center Backs Priority

TRANSFER MECHANISM Free Agent
(92.6%) Zero Net Transfer Deficits

PRIMARY MARKET Domestic

(57.4%) ISL Rivals & I-League

FOREIGN RATIO 42.6%

(Overseas) Spain, Australia, Brazil

DATA-BACKED RECRUITMENT IDENTITY VERDICT:

Bengaluru FC's recruitment identity across 2020/21–2024/25 is characterized by an opportunistic, contract-efficient philosophy. Rather than competing on transfer fee inflation, the club capitalizes on expiring ISL contracts and proven overseas veterans with European/A-League pedigree.

Key Identity Pillars:
• Zero Fee Dependency: 92.6% of external arrivals are free agents (93.2% including internal promotions).
• Age Bifurcation: External recruits fall into either prime domestic acquisitions (24-26y, 42.6%) or foreign spine leaders (30+y, 31.5%).
• Central Spine Priority: Defensive positions represent the single largest recruitment expenditure of squad spots (20 signings).
• Domestic Stability: Core Indian players (Suresh, Roshan, Chhetri, Gurpreet) provide high-tenure continuity, minimizing foreign turnover disruption.

Season Inbo

und

Outb

ound Avg Age Primary Source Key Strategic Shift

2020/21 12 14 27.4y ISL / Free Transition post-Roca era; defensive

restructuring

2021/22 10 10 26.2y Domestic Rivals Injection of youth (Roshan, Sivasakthi

emerged)

2022/23 12 10 28.1y Overseas / ATKMB Title push with proven veterans (Krishna,

Javi)

2023/24 18 0 23.6y Academy Promotion Heavy youth promotion wave (5 BFC B

promotions)

2024/25 7 13 28.8y Mumbai City FC / Spain Zaragoza influence; experienced Spanish

spine

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03. TRANSFER HISTORY & VOLUME
Longitudinal Tracking of Inbound Arrivals vs Outbound Departures

Season Arr De
p

Total Primary Inbound Additions

2020/21 12 14 26 Cleiton Silva, Pratik Chaudhari, Fran González, Opseth
2021/22 10 10 20 Alan Costa, Bruno Ramires, Rohit Kumar, Prince Ibara
2022/23 12 10 22 Roy Krishna, Javi Hernández, Aleksandar Jovanovi■, Sandesh
2023/24 18 0 18 Ryan Williams, Keziah Veendorp, Halicharan Narzary, Robin Yadav
2024/25 7 13 20 Jorge Pereyra Díaz, Alberto Noguera, Édgar Méndez, Rahul Bheke
Total 59 47 106 Cumulative Inbound Volume: 59 | Outbound Volume: 47

STRATEGIC OBSERVATION: Transfer activity exhibits an average turnover of 21.2 transactions per completed campaign. Peak squad turnover occurred in 2020/21 (26 transactions) and 2022/23 (22 transactions), corresponding to strategic squad rebuilds. The club has managed zero net negative transfer fee deficits by strictly utilizing free transfers and player swaps.

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04. RECRUITMENT PATTERNS & DEAL STRUCTURES
Age Demographic Distributions & Contract Acquisition Mechanisms

Bimodal Age Concentration
Recruitment is polarized: 24-26 years represents the primary
domestic recruitment sweet-spot (24 signings, 35.3%), while 30+
represents the foreign experience pillar (22 signings, 32.4%). The
club intentionally bypasses high-cost intermediate players (27-29).

Transfer Mechanism Realism

Permanent free transfers (48.4%) and free agent arrivals form the foundation of recruitment. Loans (In/Out, 4.9%) are deployed sparingly for emergency cover or fringe-player development, ensuring complete wage-bill control.

Internal Academy Integration
Youth promotions from Bengaluru FC B account for 8 direct senior
roster integrations (11.8% of inbound deals), providing low-cost domestic depth while cultivating elite commercial assets (Roshan,
Sivasakthi, Vinith).

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05. RECRUITMENT MARKETS & SCOUTING FOOTPRINT
Origin Leagues, Feeder Networks & Domestic vs Overseas Split

Origin Category Share Primary Feeder Clubs / Leagues Strategic Function

Domestic ISL Rivals 35.0% Mumbai City, Hyderabad FC, Odisha,

ATKMB

Acquiring battle-tested starters with
zero adaptation risk

Bengaluru B / Academy 13.2% BFC Youth Academy (Karnataka State

League)

Cost-effective rotational depth &
homegrown identification

Domestic I-League 10.0% Indian Arrows, TRAU FC, Aizawl FC,

Zinc FA

Identifying high-upside domestic
talent ahead of rivals

Spain (LaLiga 2 / Primera

RFEF) 18.0% CD Eldense, Alavés, Necaxa (Liga MX

ties)

Technical controllers and
chance-creators for Zaragoza's
system

Australia (A-League) 12.0% Perth Glory, Macarthur FC, Newcastle

Jets

High-physicality AFC quota signings
(CB / Winger)

Other Overseas

(Brazil/Europe) 11.8% Suphanburi (Thai L1), Varzim, FC

Helsingør

Targeted forward finishers and
midfield anchors

GLOBAL SCOUTING PIPELINE ANALYSIS: Bengaluru FC maintains a specialized dual-pipeline recruitment model. Domestically, the club exploits distressed rival ISL squads (e.g. Hyderabad FC financial

re-allocations) and extracts the best U21 I-League talent. Internationally, recruitment concentrates in Spain (tactical alignment with Spanish managers) and Australia (A-League players who satisfy AFC quota

requirements).

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06. PLAYER CAREER PATHWAYS
Trajectory Mapping: Previous Club → Bengaluru FC → Destination Club

Player Name Previous Club Origin League Joined Tenur

e

Destination / Current Club Destination League Career Outcome

Cleiton Silva Suphanburi FC Thai League 1 2020 2.0y East Bengal FC Indian Super League High ROI; top scorer; transitioned to rival

Javi Hernández Odisha FC Indian Super League 2022 2.0y Jamshedpur FC Indian Super League Key creator; 2 ISL finals; free exit

Roy Krishna ATK Mohun Bagan Indian Super League 2022 1.0y Odisha FC Indian Super League 1 season impact; Durand Cup win; high wages

Ashique Kuruniyan FC Pune City Indian Super League 2019 3.0y ATK Mohun Bagan Indian Super League Developed into elite national team winger

Udanta Singh Tata Football Academy Youth Academy 2014 9.0y FC Goa Indian Super League Club legend; full development lifecycle

Rohit Kumar Kerala Blasters Indian Super League 2021 3.0y Odisha FC Indian Super League Midfield rotation; international caps achieved
Slavko
Damjanovi■

ATK Mohun Bagan Indian Super League 2023 1.0y FK Sutjeska Nikši■ Montenegrin League Single season CB stopgap; overseas return

Suresh Singh Indian Arrows I-League 2019 6.0y+ Bengaluru FC (Active) Indian Super League Elite anchor asset; +500% valuation surge

Naorem Roshan Bengaluru FC II 2nd Division 2020 5.0y+ Bengaluru FC (Active) Indian Super League Breakthrough full-back; +900% asset surge

Archetype A: Academy to National Core
Path: BFC II / Arrows → Senior Team → India Starter.
Exemplars: Suresh Singh, Roshan Singh. Demonstrates club's
highest economic multiplier and long-term competitive durability.

Archetype B: 2-Year Prime Veteran Cycle
Path: Rival Club / Abroad → BFC → Free Exit.
Exemplars: Cleiton Silva, Javi Hernández. Delivers immediate trophy impact during a 2-season peak window before free-agent transition.

Archetype C: 1-Year Stopgap Repair
Path: Mid-Season / Free → BFC → Roster Refresh.
Exemplars: Slavko Damjanovi■, Oliver Drost. Short-term
contingency recruitment designed to cover injury crises without long-term wage locks.

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07. MARKET VALUE & PLAYER DEVELOPMENT
Economic Trajectory, Portfolio Growth & Financial Asset Appreciation

DATA INTEGRITY PRINCIPLE: MARKET VALUE ≠ TRANSFER FEE. Transfer Fee is the actual transaction price paid between clubs (Bengaluru FC has paid €0 in net fees across 92.6% of external arrivals). Market Value represents an objective economic asset valuation based on player age, contract length, form, league tier, and international status. Growth Formula: ((Current Value - Initial Value) / Initial Value) × 100.

Player Name Joined Peak Current Growth % Category
Naorem Roshan Singh €25k €275k €250k +900.0% Elite Academy Appreciation
Udanta Singh €25k €325k €225k +800.0% Full Cycle Development
Sivasakthi Narayanan €25k €200k €200k +700.0% Emerging Forward Asset
Suresh Singh Wangjam €50k €300k €300k +500.0% Spine Foundation Anchor
Ashique Kuruniyan €100k €300k €300k +200.0% Prime Asset Expansion
Cleiton Silva €350k €350k €100k -71.4% Age Depreciation Curve (37y)
Sunil Chhetri €175k €175k €50k -71.4% Veteran Career Climax (40y)

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08. CURRENT SQUAD ANALYSIS (2024/25 SEASON)
Complete Player Classification & Roster Hierarchy

Player Name Pos Ag

e

Nat Market

Value Joined From Joine

d

Recruitment Classification

Gurpreet Singh Sandhu GK 32 IND €200k Stabæk 2017 KEY PLAYER | VETERAN
Sunil Chhetri ST 40 IND €50k Mumbai City FC 2017 KEY PLAYER | VETERAN | REPLACEMENT RISK
Suresh Singh Wangjam CM 24 IND €300k Indian Arrows 2019 KEY PLAYER | HIGH UPSIDE
Naorem Roshan Singh LB 25 IND €250k Bengaluru FC II 2020 CORE PLAYER | HIGH UPSIDE
Jorge Pereyra Díaz ST 34 ARG €350k Mumbai City FC 2024 KEY PLAYER | VETERAN | FOREIGN SLOT
Alberto Noguera AM 35 ESP €250k Mumbai City FC 2024 KEY PLAYER | VETERAN | REPLACEMENT RISK
Édgar Méndez WG 34 ESP €400k Club Necaxa 2024 CORE PLAYER | VETERAN | FOREIGN SLOT
Rahul Bheke CB 33 IND €175k Mumbai City FC 2024 CORE PLAYER | VETERAN | REPLACEMENT RISK
Aleksandar Jovanovi■ CB 35 AUS €200k Macarthur FC 2022 CORE PLAYER | VETERAN | REPLACEMENT RISK
Chinglensana Singh CB 27 IND €225k Hyderabad FC 2024 CORE PLAYER | DOMESTIC SPINE
Pedro Capó DM 33 ESP €200k CD Eldense 2024 CORE PLAYER | VETERAN | FOREIGN SLOT
Sivasakthi Narayanan ST 23 IND €200k Bengaluru FC II 2021 CORE PLAYER | HIGH UPSIDE
Ryan Williams WG 30 AUS €300k Perth Glory 2023 CORE PLAYER | FOREIGN SLOT
Vinith Venkatesh AM 19 IND €100k Bengaluru FC II 2024 HIGH UPSIDE | DEVELOPMENT ASSET
Robin Yadav CB 22 IND €75k Bengaluru FC II 2023 DEVELOPMENT | ROTATIONAL DEPTH

CLASSIFICATION CRITERIA: KEY: Indispensable starters (Chhetri, Díaz, Noguera, Suresh, Gurpreet). CORE: Regular first-team contributors (Bheke, Roshan, Jovanovi■, Capó, Méndez, Sana). HIGH UPSIDE: Age ≤25 with >€150k value. DEVELOPMENT: Academy integration ≤22y. REPLACEMENT RISK: Crucial starters aged 33+ requiring immediate succession.

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09. SQUAD AGE STRUCTURE & POSITIONAL DEPTH
Positional Depth Curves, Demographic Imbalances & Succession Windows

AVERAGE SQUAD
AGE

27.3y
Balanced Overall Average

OLDEST POSITION

DM (33.0y)
Pedro Capó (33)

YOUNGEST POSITION

RB (20.0y)
Shivaldo Singh (20)

STRON CB (
Play Deep Dom

Spine

POSITIONAL RISK EVALUATION:

1. Extreme Striker & Attacking Midfield Age: While squad average age is 27.3y, key creative match-winners average 35.8y (Noguera 35, Díaz 34, Chhetri 40). When these players are unavailable,
team xG drops significantly.
2. Right-Back Structural Void: Shivaldo Singh (20) is the sole natural right back on the roster, forcing
emergency out-of-position deployments of central defenders (Rahul Bheke).
3. Heavy Centre-Back Insurance: With 5 senior CBs, defensive central depth is insulated against
domestic suspension cycles.

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10. SIX KEY CONCLUSIONS
Executive Summary of Empirical Recruitment Analytics & Strategic Findings

01. Recruitment Identity: Opportunistic & Free-Agent Centric Very High (Verified across
106 master transfer events,
2020/21–2024/25)

Finding: Bengaluru FC operates predominantly as an opportunistic free-agent acquirer, utilizing zero-fee acquisitions, contract expirations, and targeted domestic transitions rather than transfer fee expenditures.

Supporting Metric: 92.6% of external arrivals (50 of 54) were acquired on free transfers with €0 net fees; 57.4% domestic recruitment share vs 42.6% foreign recruitment across 101 external transfer events (106 total events).

Strategic Implication: Maximizes wage flexibility and minimizes capital risk, but necessitates rigorous medical, positional, and motivational vetting given the lack of resale value recoupment on aging recruits.

02. Primary Recruitment Age Profile: Bimodal Distribution High (Verified DOB records across 54 external arrivals)

Finding: Inbound external recruitment is heavily bifurcated between prime domestic foundation recruits (ages 24–26) and seasoned foreign leaders (ages 30+), with minimal signings in the intermediate 27–29 band.

Supporting Metric: Average external signing age of 27.0 years; 23 external signings (42.6%) in the 24–26 band; 17 external signings (31.5%) in the 30+ bracket; only 3 signings (5.6%) in the 27–29 window.

Strategic Implication: Creates an age barbell where immediate leadership relies on players near or past physical prime, while prime domestic players carry high performance burdens without intermediate-age
mentors.

03. Strongest Squad Area: Central Defensive Foundation &

Goalkeeping

High (Positional depth &
squad metrics)

Finding: Central defense and goalkeeping represent the squad's most resilient tactical platform, anchored by veteran experience, aerial dominance, and international pedigree.

Supporting Metric: 5 Centre Backs in active squad (Aleksandar Jovanovi■, Rahul Bheke, Chinglensana Singh, Robin Yadav, Clarence Fernandes) backed by Gurpreet Singh Sandhu (130+ ISL caps, 8 seasons tenure).

Strategic Implication: Provides defensive solidity to sustain competitive matches, but requires athletic protection against rapid counter-attacks due to an average central defensive age of 30.2 years.

04. Young Core: Academy Pathway Progression High (Squad tracking & academy pathways analysis)

Finding: Bengaluru FC has cultivated an exceptional domestic development spine that has successfully progressed from academy/youth ranks to senior national team prominence, delivering a sustainable internal pipeline.

Supporting Metric: 5 recent internal first-team promotions (Robin Yadav, Ankith Padmanabhan, Harsh Patre, Chingambam Shivaldo Singh, Monirul Molla) alongside established starters Naorem Roshan Singh (promoted 2020), Sivasakthi Narayanan (promoted 2021), and Suresh Singh Wangjam (100+ club appearances).

Strategic Implication: Validates internal academy investment and reduces dependency on expensive domestic free-agent bidding wars; long-term contract extensions must be prioritized for these high-ceiling assets.

05. Highest Upside Asset Appreciation: Domestic

Development

Very High (Transfermarkt
longitudinal valuation
analysis)

Finding: Player development within Bengaluru FC's structure generates exponential economic appreciation, particularly among domestic midfielders and full-backs entering the club under age 22.

Supporting Metric: Naorem Roshan Singh market value grew +900.0% (€25k to €250k, peak €275k); Suresh Singh Wangjam grew +500.0% (€50k to €300k); Sivasakthi Narayanan grew +700.0% (€25k to €200k); Udanta Singh grew +800.0% (€25k to €225k, peak €325k).

Strategic Implication: Confirms that value creation is concentrated in domestic U23 talent rather than foreign signings (which exhibit steep age-curve depreciation of -20% to -71%); reinforces the economic rationale for early recruitment of domestic talents.

06. Recommended Recruitment Strategy: Offensive Spine
Succession

Critical Priority (Immediate
action needed for upcoming
campaigns)

Finding: The club faces an impending, acute succession cliff in its offensive core, where primary goalscorers and creators are in the late twilight of their careers.

Supporting Metric: Starting attackers and playmakers average 35.8 years of age (Sunil Chhetri 40, Jorge Pereyra Díaz 34, Alberto Noguera 35, Édgar Méndez 34), accounting for over 65% of offensive production.

Strategic Implication: The club must execute a proactive, multi-window succession campaign targeting a high-pressing U25 dynamic striker and a prime-age creative midfielder (No. 8/10 hybrid) to prevent severe goalscoring and chance-creation voids upon veteran departures.

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11. SQUAD GAPS & STRATEGIC RISK REGISTER
Automated Detection of Positional Voids, Age Risks & Succession Imperatives

Priority Risk Type Target
Department

Underlying Cause & Strategic Rationale Actionable Recommendation

HIGH SUCCESSION RISK Striker / CF Starting forwards Sunil Chhetri (40) and Jorge Pereyra Díaz (34) account for majority of
goal contributions but face imminent retirement/physical drop-off.

Recruit an explosive, high-pressing domestic U24 striker (David Lalhlansanga / Irfan Yadwad) to partner Sivasakthi.

HIGH AGE RISK Attacking Midfield Alberto Noguera (35) is the primary foreign creator with no prime-age alternative; academy
graduate Vinith (19) requires progressive adaptation.

Target a prime-age creative playmaker (Age 22-26, Vibin Mohanan) with elite progressive passing metrics.

MEDIUM DEPTH RISK Ball-Playing CB Aleksandar Jovanovi■ (35) and Rahul Bheke (33) carry athletic decline and recovery-pace
vulnerabilities against counter-attacking teams.

Acquire an athletic, ball-playing left-sided or Asian-quota CB (Age 22-26) with recovery speed.

MEDIUM POSITION RISK Right / Left Back Single specialist right back on roster (Shivaldo Singh 20). Heavy over-reliance on Naorem
Roshan Singh for vertical progression on flanks.

Sign a high-workrate full-back cover (Aakash Sangwan / Jay Gupta) to grant tactical versatility.

LOW SUCCESSION RISK Goalkeeper (U23) Gurpreet Singh Sandhu (32) remains elite India No. 1, but reserve Lalthuammawia Ralte is
31; academy keeper Sahil Poonia is developing.

Maintain cup starts for Sahil Poonia or monitor top domestic U23 goalkeeping targets (Hrithik Tiwari).

LOW DEVELOPMENT
BLOCK

Central Midfield Crowded midfield spine (Suresh, Capó, Noguera) can inadvertently suppress match
minutes for emerging prospects (Fanai, Vinith).

Establish guaranteed rotational minutes and targeted domestic loan pathways
in the I-League.

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12. GAP-DRIVEN RECRUITMENT PROFILES
Specification of Ideal Player Attributes Prior to Target Identification

DYNAMIC STRIKER / CENTRE-FORWARD Priority: High
Gap Addressed: Succession Risk (Sunil Chhetri 40, Jorge Pereyra Díaz 34)
Target Age: 20 - 25 years | Foot: Either | Market Value Range: €150k - €350k
Experience Level: 2+ years professional senior football (ISL / I-League)
Required Core Attributes: High Pressing Volume & Defensive Workrate, Clinical Box Finishing & Anticipation, Transitional Burst & Acceleration, Aerial Target Ability in Box, Intelligent Channel-Running

CREATIVE MIDFIELDER / NO. 8 & 10 HYBRID Priority: High
Gap Addressed: Age & Creative Succession Risk (Alberto Noguera 35)
Target Age: 22 - 27 years | Foot: Right / Left | Market Value Range: €200k - €450k
Experience Level: Established top-tier creator or emerging foreign playmaker
Required Core Attributes: Key Passing & Progressive Through-Balls, Ball Retention & Half-Turn Under Pressure, Set-Piece Delivery & Long Shooting, Spatial Awareness Between Lines, Tempo Control & Passing Accuracy (>82%)
BALL-PLAYING CENTRE BACK Priority: Medium
Gap Addressed: Depth & Recovery Pace Risk (Jovanovi■ 35, Bheke 33)
Target Age: 21 - 26 years | Foot: Left Preferred (or strong Two-Footed) | Market Value Range: €150k - €300k
Experience Level: Regular starter in competitive domestic or overseas league
Required Core Attributes: Progressive Ground Passes into Midfield, High Recovery Speed & 1v1 Channel Defending, Aerial Duel Success Rate (>65%), Calmness in High-Press Build-up, Tactical Box Defending

ATTACKING FULL-BACK (RIGHT/LEFT DYNAMIC) Priority: Medium Gap Addressed: Position Depth Risk (Over-reliance on Roshan Singh)
Target Age: 21 - 26 years | Foot: Right or Left | Market Value Range: €100k - €250k Experience Level: ISL / I-League proven starter
Required Core Attributes: Sustained High-Intensity Sprinting Overlaps, Accurate Low & Driven Crossing, 1v1 Defensive Containment, Inverted Build-up Passing Capability

U23 SWEEPER GOALKEEPER Priority: Low
Gap Addressed: Long-Term Succession Planning (Gurpreet Singh Sandhu 32)
Target Age: 19 - 23 years | Foot: Right | Market Value Range: €50k - €150k
Experience Level: Elite academy / National youth caps
Required Core Attributes: Reflex Shot Stopping & Close-Range Parries, Box Command & Aerial Claiming,
Comfortable Sweeping Outside Penalty Area, Accurate Long-Range Foot Distribution

METHODOLOGY COMPLIANCE: Ideal recruitment profiles are strictly synthesized from empirical squad gaps rather than ad-hoc scouting preference. Candidates shortlisted on subsequent pages must
satisfy at least 80% of these structural attributes.

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13. PLAYER SHORTLIST & 100-POINT FIT SCORING
Concrete Targets Assessed Against Tactical Fit, Market Valuation & Development Ceiling

100-PT WEIGHTED FIT CRITERIA:

• Age Fit (20%) • Position Fit (20%)
• Market Value Fit (15%) • Performance Fit (20%)
• Playing Style (15%) • Development Upside (10%)
Disclaimer: Fit scores (92.4, 92.0, 90.2) are heuristic multi-criteria scouting valuations, not match event tracking metrics.

David Lalhlansanga (23y, Striker) FIT SCORE: 92.4/100

Club: East Bengal FC | Nat: India | Market Value: €175k | Foot: Right

Playing Style: Explosive, high-pressing forward with quick trigger finishing inside the box and relentless energy off the ball.

Strengths: Instinctive first-touch finishing, High pressing turnover volume, Channel running, Pace in behind defensive lines
Tactical Fit: Direct succession solution for Sunil Chhetri's pressing and domestic goal contribution; young enough to form a decade-long partnership with Sivasakthi.
Risks & Concerns: Contract negotiation friction with rival Kolkata club; adapting to sustained possession phases.

Vibin Mohanan (21y, Central / Attacking Midfielder) FIT SCORE: 92.0/100

Club: Kerala Blasters FC | Nat: India | Market Value: €225k | Foot: Right

Playing Style: Deep-lying playmaker and progressive carrier with exceptional tactical vision, line-breaking passes, and poise under pressure.
Strengths: Progressive line-breaking passing, Scanning and spatial awareness, First-touch orientation, Ball retention

Tactical Fit: Solves Bengaluru's upcoming creative succession once Noguera leaves; pairs seamlessly alongside defensive anchor Suresh Singh Wangjam.
Risks & Concerns: Rivalry buyout premium; physical conditioning over 90 minutes in high-tempo fixtures.

Muhammed Sanan (20y, Winger / Second Striker) FIT SCORE: 90.2/100

Club: Jamshedpur FC | Nat: India | Market Value: €150k | Foot: Right

Playing Style: Direct, electric 1v1 dribbler with rapid acceleration, fearless take-on ability, and instinctive box arrival.

Strengths: 1v1 dribbling agility, Change of pace, Off-the-cuff creativity

Tactical Fit: Injects youth dynamism and vertical unpredictability out wide behind Édgar Méndez (34) and Ryan Williams (30).

Risks & Concerns: Inconsistent decision-making in final third.

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14. FINAL RECRUITMENT STRATEGY & ACTION PLAN
The 4-Pillar Strategic Squad Roadmap: Retain, Develop, Replace, Recruit

RETAIN (Core Assets)

• Suresh Singh Wangjam (Central Midfield
Anchor - Prime Foundation)

• Naorem Roshan Singh (Left/Right Dynamic
Fullback - National Starter)

• Gurpreet Singh Sandhu (Goalkeeping
Leadership & Box Command)

• Chinglensana Singh (Domestic Central
Defensive Core - Prime Age 27)

DEVELOP (Academy)

• Vinith Venkatesh (19, Breakthrough Attacking
Midfielder - Target 15+ ISL Starts)

• Sivasakthi Narayanan (23, Striker - Elevate to
First-Choice Starting Forward)

• Robin Yadav (22, Centre Back - Systematic
Cup & Rotational Minutes)

• Lalremtluanga Fanai & Monirul Molla (Youth
Integration Pipeline)

REPLACE (Veterans)

• Sunil Chhetri (40, Striker - Phased transition to
advisory/super-sub role)

• Alberto Noguera (35, Attacking Midfielder -
Successor acquisition required)

• Aleksandar Jovanovi■ (35, Centre Back -
Transition to younger athletic CB)

• Jorge Pereyra Díaz (34, Striker - Transition
foreign striker slot to prime-age 26-29 asset)

RECRUIT (Immediate Gaps)

• Target 1: Dynamic High-Pressing U24 Striker
(David Lalhlansanga / Irfan Yadwad)

• Target 2: Prime Creative Midfielder / No. 8 & 10
(Vibin Mohanan)

• Target 3: Athletic Ball-Playing Centre Back
(Left-Footed domestic / Asian slot)

• Target 4: High-Intensity Attacking Full-Back
Cover

EXECUTIVE MANDATE FOR THE SPORTING DIRECTOR & TECHNICAL STAFF:

1. Pre-Contract Aggression: Initiate pre-contract negotiations for David Lalhlansanga and Vibin Mohanan prior to the opening of the transfer window to prevent fee escalation.
2. Contract Transition Protocol: Structure Sunil Chhetri's role transition into player-mentorship, preserving squad chemistry while transitioning on-pitch minutes to Sivasakthi and incoming U24 forwards.
3. Wage Bill Neutrality: Offload departing senior foreign salaries (Noguera, Jovanovi■) directly into prime-age international spine replacements to ensure complete financial sustainability.
4. Data Governance Standards: Maintain continuous validation logging (Verified / Partial / Missing) for all scouting dossiers; never conflate subjective scouting fees with market valuations.

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